K

How to use KeelRace

A click-by-click guide for architects. Models may propose wording, drivers, and candidate splits. You lock, select, cite, and approve. Nothing becomes official because a model wrote it.

User guide · KeelRace workspace · Open from the sidebar as “User guide”

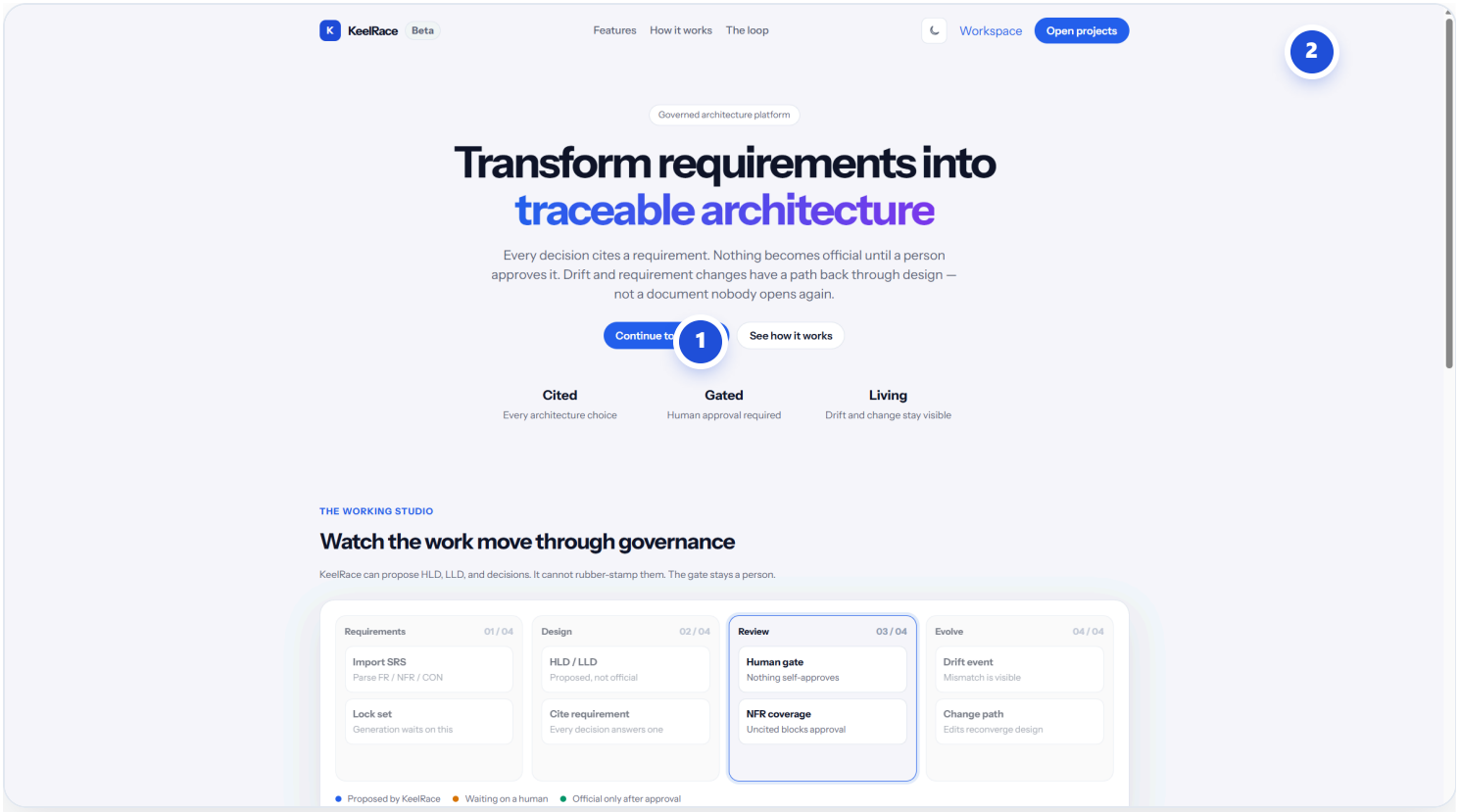
What you will do

1. Sign in and create a project
2. Create a RequirementSet
3. Enter requirements — import or add one by one
4. Run critic and driver cards
5. Lock, then record NFRs
6. Propose candidates, then generate the HLD
7. Cite quality rules and approve in Review Queue
8. ADRs, evidence, skeleton, change

> LampCheck (Demo project) and How this works are a filled example. Do not treat them as your architecture. Agent test is for a live project you own, not the demo.

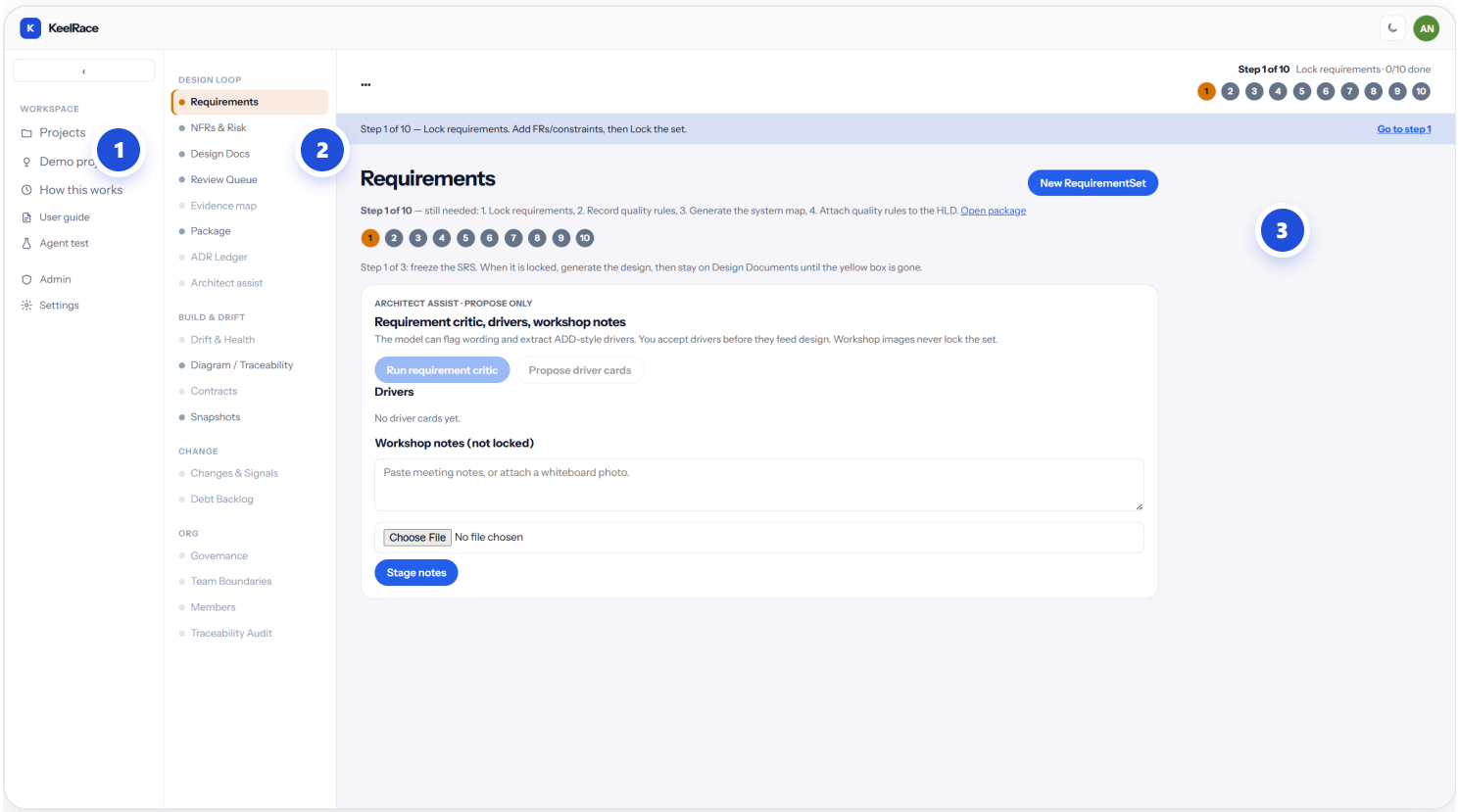
1. Sign in and create a project

1. Open KeelRace. If you are not signed in, click **Workspace** or go to **/login**.
2. Enter your email and password. Click **Sign in**. First visit: **Need an account? Sign up**, confirm email, then sign in.
3. You land on **Projects**. Click the blue **New project** button (top right).
4. In the dialog, type a name (your product, not “test”). Click **Create**.
5. The new row is clickable. Click the name. You are now in that project’s workspace.



1 **Continue to projects** — workspace if you already have an account.

2 **Open projects / Workspace** — same destination from the top bar.



1 Left rail: **Projects**, **Demo project**, **How this works**, **User guide** (this PDF).

2 **Design loop** — work top to bottom the first time: Requirements → NFRs → Design Docs → Review Queue → …

3 **New RequirementSet** — first click inside a new project.

2. Create a RequirementSet

1. On **Requirements**, click **New RequirementSet**.
2. A version chip appears, e.g. **v1 draft**. That is the working SRS. You can have several versions later; generation always uses a *locked* set.
3. Until it is locked you will see two ways to fill it: **Import from a document** and **Add one requirement manually**. You do not have to use both.

> The critic buttons stay disabled until a set exists. Create the set first, then run assist.

3. Enter requirements

Pick path A (import) or path B (type them). Mixing is allowed: import the bulk, then add the gaps by hand.

Path A — Import from a document

1. Stay on Requirements with a **draft** set selected (not locked).
2. Find the card **Import from a document**.
3. Leave **Upload .docx/.pdf** selected, or click **Paste text** if you already copied the SRS.
4. Upload: click the file control, choose a **.docx** or **.pdf**. Paste: put the raw text in the box.
5. Click **Extract & parse**. Wait. You get a review list, nothing is saved yet.
6. For each row: keep or clear the checkbox; edit **Ref code** (FR-1, CON-1, NFR-A); set type **FR / NFR / CON**; fix title and body.
7. Click **Import N selected**. FR and CON become requirements on this set. NFRs go to the **NFRs & Risk** tab, not the FR list.

What that card looks like

Import from a document — already have an SRS? Bring it in instead of retyping.

Upload .docx/.pdf | **Paste text**

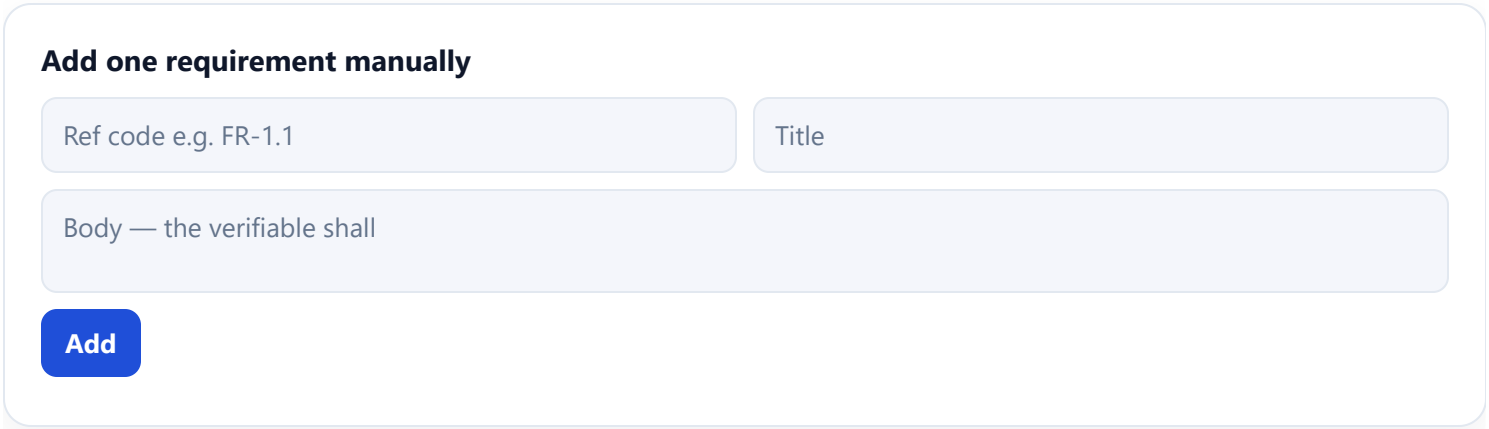
Choose File — no file chosen

Extract & parse

After extract you will see checkboxes, ref codes, type dropdowns, titles, bodies, then **Import N selected**.

Path B — Add one by one

1. On the same draft set, scroll to **Add one requirement manually**.
2. In **Ref code** type `FR-1` (or CON-1, NFR-1). Keep the prefix consistent; the UI filters by FR / NFR / CON from this code.
3. In **Title** type a short name, e.g. `Turn the lamp on and off`.
4. In **Body** type the shall-statement. One demand per row. If you need “and also”, add a second requirement.
5. Click **Add**. The card appears in the list below.
6. Repeat for each FR, CON, and any NFR you want as a requirement row. Extra quality rules can wait for NFRs & Risk.
7. Pencil edits the row. Trash deletes it — only while the set is draft.

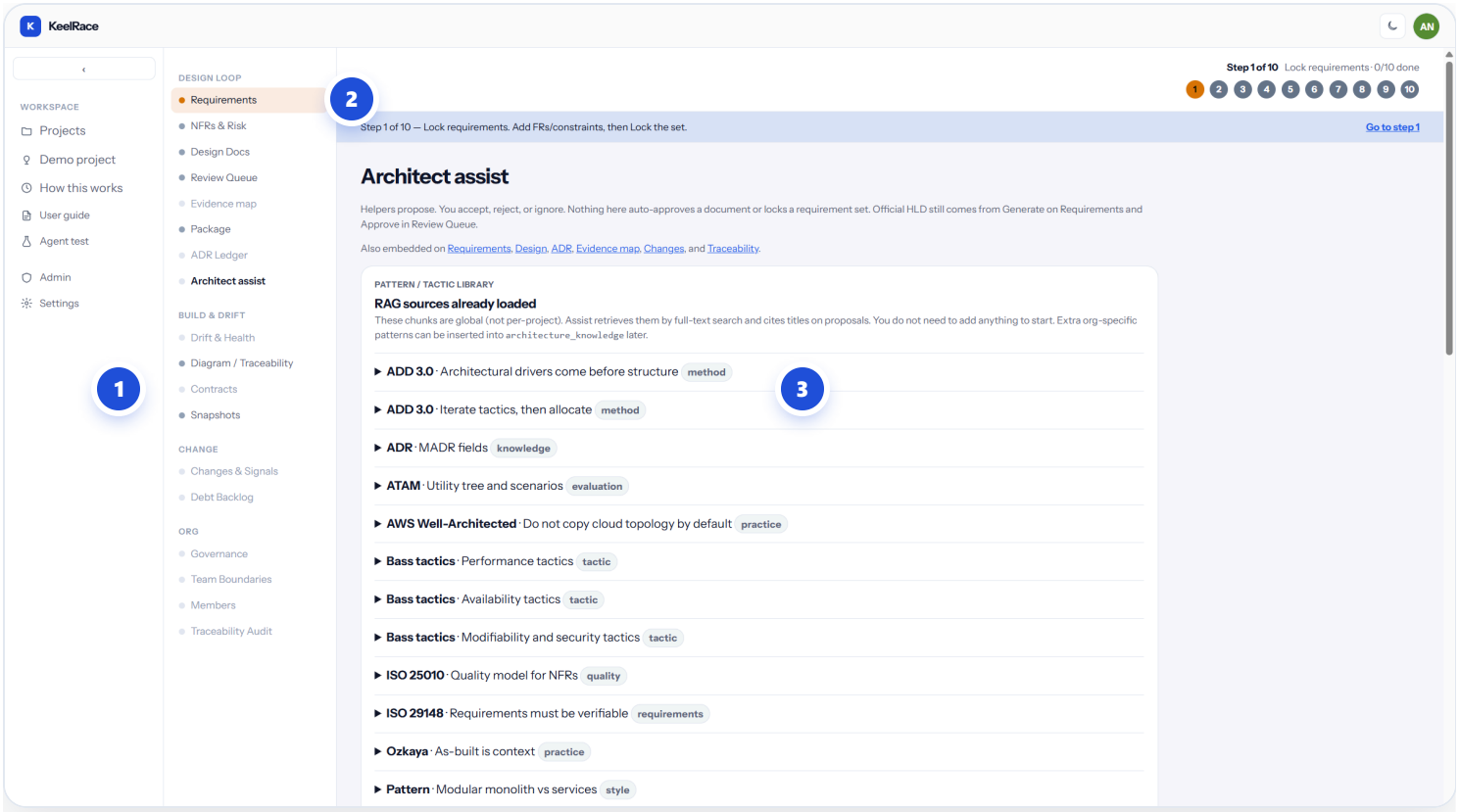


> After **Lock**, those fields disappear. You cannot silently edit a frozen SRS. Use **Changes & Signals**.

4. Critic and drivers (still draft or after lock)

You can run these as soon as the set has rows. They write proposals only.

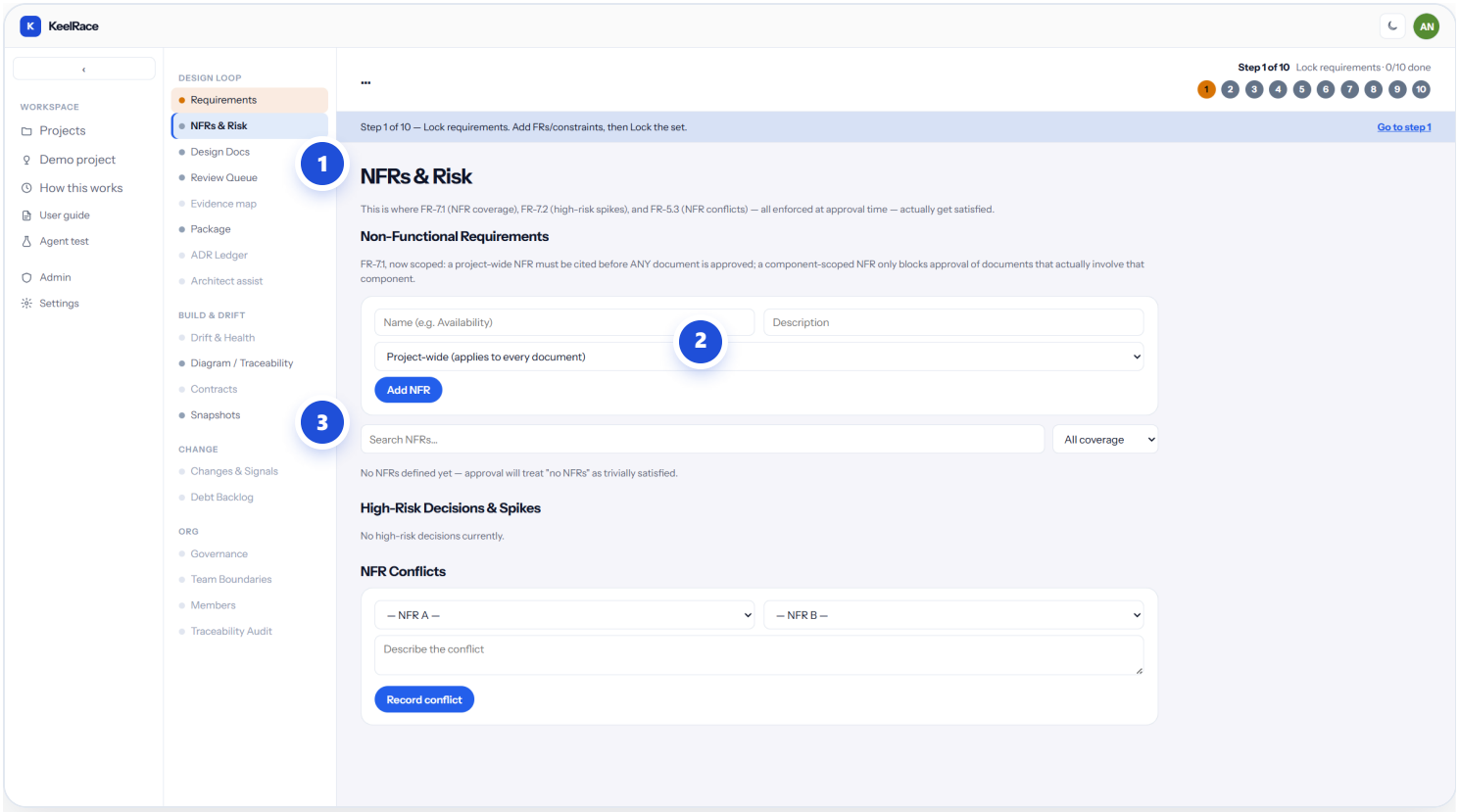
1. On Requirements, in **Architect assist · propose only**, click **Run requirement critic**.
2. Read each finding. **Keep** if you agree. **Dismiss** if the model is wrong (compound CON that is really one constraint).
3. If the set is still draft and there is a rewrite: **Apply rewrite to draft** updates that requirement’s body. You still own the wording.
4. Click **Propose driver cards**. Each card is stimulus / environment / response.
5. Click **Accept driver** for the ones that will shape the split. **Reject** scale-out or cloud if the SRS never asked.
6. Optional: paste workshop notes or attach a whiteboard photo, then **Stage notes**. Staging does not lock.



1. **User guide** — this PDF, always a new tab.
2. **Architect assist** — same helpers as on Requirements, plus candidates, Ask, ATAM, mappings.
3. **RAG sources already loaded** — expand a title to read the chunk. You do not upload a corpus to start.

5. Lock the set, then NFRs

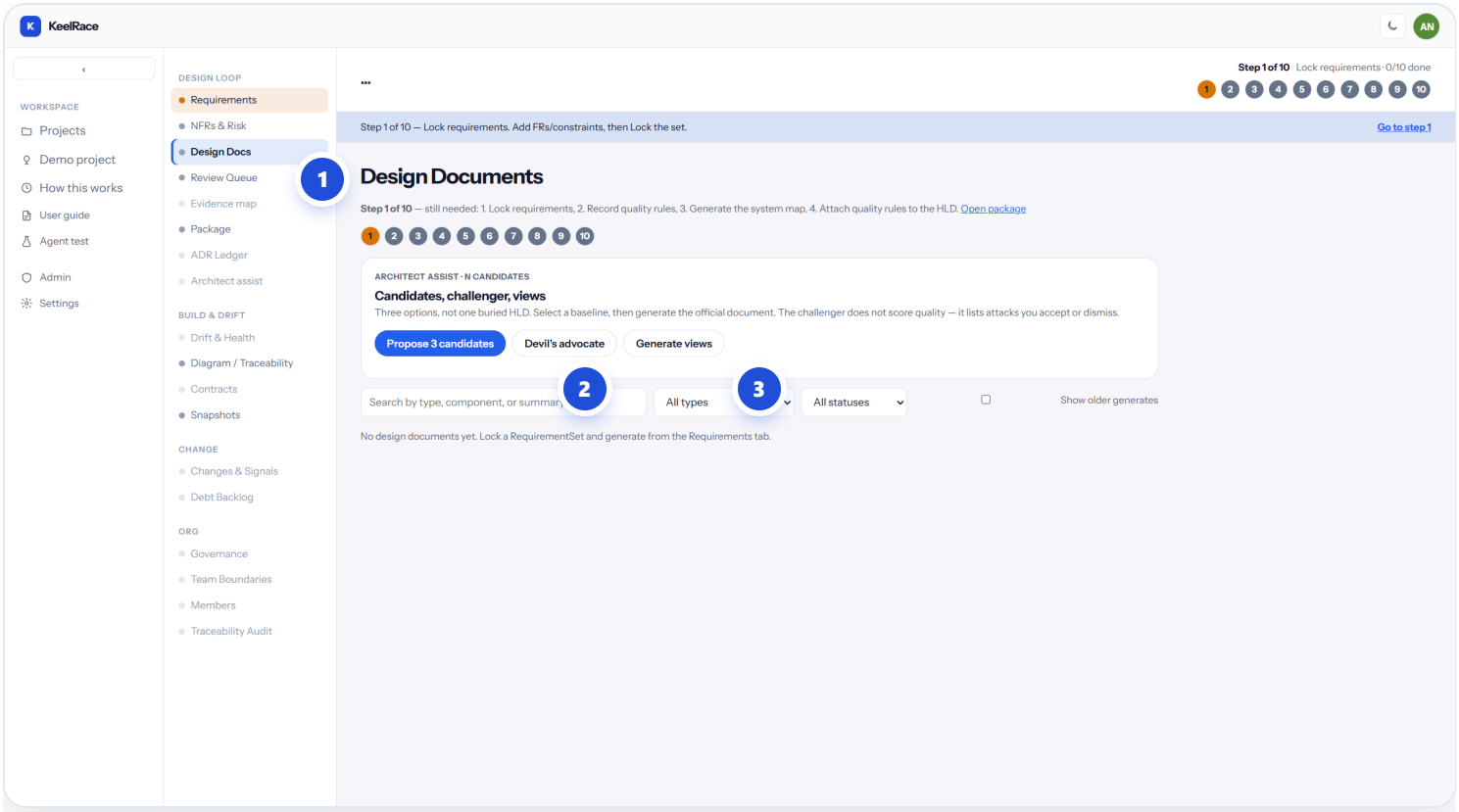
1. On the RequirementSet card, click **Lock**. Confirm if asked. The badge becomes locked.
2. **Generate HLD/LLD (FR-1.1)** is still grey until lock succeeds. Do not generate yet if you have not accepted drivers.
3. Click **NFRs & Risk** in the Design loop.
4. Name: e.g. `Availability – local`. Description: what "good" means. Scope: usually **Project-wide**.
5. Click **Add NFR**. Repeat for safety, privacy, etc.
6. Import already created NFR rows if you classified them during parse — check this tab before duplicating.



1. Open **NFRs & Risk**.
2. Fill **Name** and **Description**.
3. Click **Add NFR**. Uncited NFRs block Approve later unless you override in the open.

6. Candidates, then generate the official map

1. Open **Design Docs** or **Architect assist**.
2. Click **Propose 3 candidates**. Wait. Read optimizes / sacrifices.
3. Click **Select as baseline** on one. **Discard** the others.
4. Click **Devil's advocate**. Keep or dismiss each attack. No score.
5. Go back to **Requirements**. On the locked set, click **Generate HLD/LLD (FR-1.1)**.
6. Wait. Open **Design Docs**. You should see HLD vN and LLDs. Status is still draft.

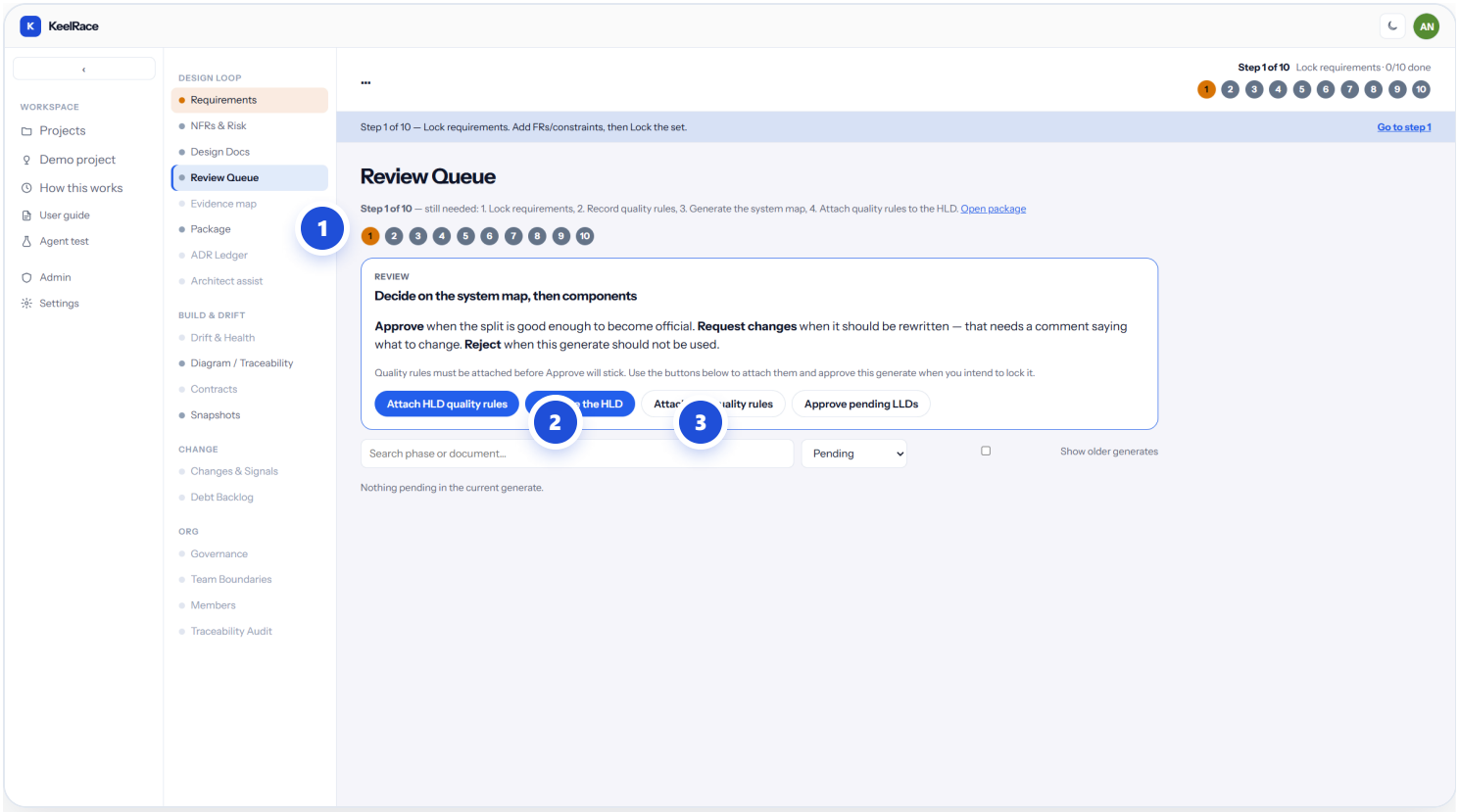


1. **Design Docs**.
2. **Propose 3 candidates** — before you treat one HLD as inevitable.
3. **Devil's advocate** — after a baseline exists (selected candidate or generated HLD).

> Generation uses accepted drivers and the selected candidate when those exist. It still does not approve the document.

7. Cite, spike, approve

1. On Design Docs, if a yellow box lists uncited NFRs: **Suggest matches**, tick decisions, **Apply** — or attach coarsely, then clean up.
2. High-risk decisions: type a spike note, **Record spike**.
3. Open **Review Queue**.
4. Read the HLD. **Approve** if the split is good enough to be official. **Request changes** needs a comment. **Reject** if this generate should not be used.
5. If Approve fails, read the error: uncited NFR, missing spike, unconfirmed component reconciliation. Fix, then approve again.
6. Repeat for LLDs.



1. **Review Queue** — the only door to official.
2. **Attach HLD quality rules** if citations are missing.
3. **Approve the HLD** — a person, not the model.

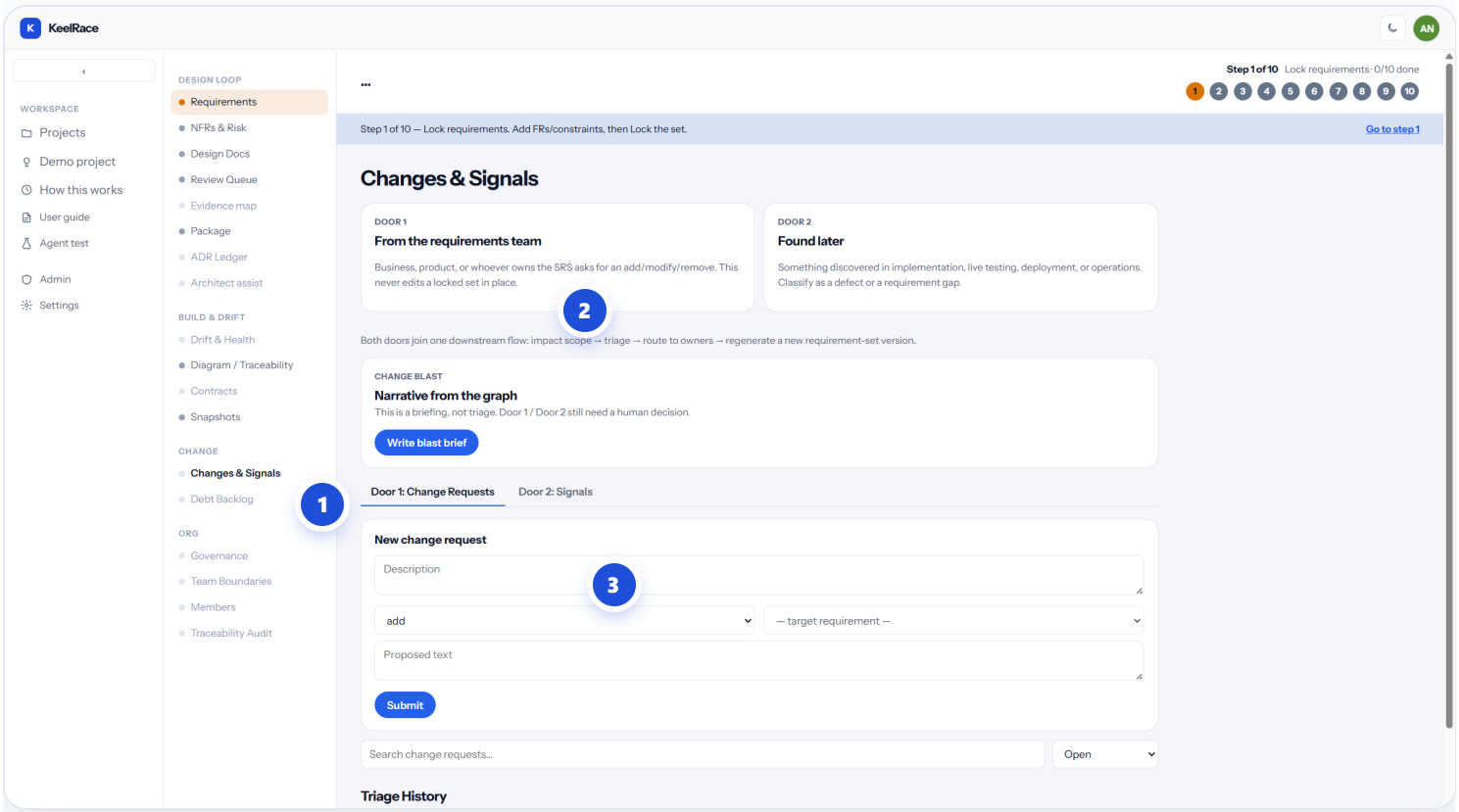
8. After approval

Screen	What you click	What it is for
ADR Ledger	Type a decision point → **Draft alternatives** → type chosen option → **Record ADR**	Copilot never fills the winner. Cite ≥1 requirement.
Evidence map	Read the table. **Ask** a question. **Generate scenarios**, mark in/out	Graph answers only. No ATAM scores as gates.
Design Docs (approved HLD)	**Prototype**, then **Skeleton**	Flow picture, then files.
Diagram / Traceability	**Propose mappings** → **Confirm mapping**	Writes design_component_id. Filename is not identity.
Snapshots	**Capture**	Freeze structure for later diff.
Package	Preview, then export	What you hand someone.

When the SRS must change

1. Open **Changes & Signals**.

2. Door 1: fill Description. Action **add / modify / remove**. For modify/remove pick the target requirement. Proposed text if you have it. **Submit**.
3. Door 2: click **Door 2: Signals**, describe what you found, **Submit**, then classify (defect vs requirement gap).
4. Optional: **Write blast brief** — a narrative, not triage.
5. Scope → reconverge → apply. That creates a **new** requirement-set version. You do not unlock and overwrite.



1 **Changes & Signals**.

2 **Write blast brief** — impact story from the graph.

3 Door 1 form: description, add/modify/remove, proposed text, **Submit**.

Rules that do not move

- Generate is rejected until the set is locked.
- Approve is rejected without a human review gate, and can fail on NFRs, spikes, or reconciliation.
- Assist never sets approved or locked.
- Do not use a quality number as a gate.
- Do not treat a filename as a component.

KeelRace user guide — models propose, people decide. Rebuild this PDF with the screenshots in /guide after a UI change.